

Chapter 1: Introduction (pp. 1-12)

Overview

Chapter 1 (pp. 1-12) is the author's (Eric Jager's) introduction to *Mastering the TOGAF Standard*. It is not technical content about the TOGAF framework itself — instead it explains why the book was written, who it is for, and how to read it. It is light on hard "quiz facts" compared to later chapters, but it does introduce vocabulary (Fundamental Content, Series Guides, Architecture Capability, ADM) and the book's navigation system (reading tours) that later chapters build on.

Detailed Section Breakdown

Introduction (unnumbered opening) (pp. 1-5)

The author frames Enterprise Architecture (EA) as a profession distinct from building/city architecture (p. 1). Architects use architecture frameworks as reference works/tools to map organizational change, interpret its impact on desired outcomes, and communicate it to stakeholders at every level (p. 1). Frameworks exist so architects don't "reinvent the wheel" — they encode the collected experience of many practitioners (pp. 1-2).

The TOGAF Standard is described as "the world's leading architecture framework," used by tens of thousands of architects for decades (p. 2). The author's motivation for writing the book is **not** that TOGAF is incomplete — if anything it can feel *overly* complete, cumbersome to apply practically, and occasionally inconsistent (p. 2). The real problem, in the author's view, is that the profession has not properly *applied* TOGAF because the framework's volume of information and its academic/fuzzy explanatory style causes architects to give up (p. 2). The book's goal is a **practical approach** that lets architects use the parts of TOGAF relevant to their own situation (p. 2).

Key point (p. 2): TOGAF is meant to be **tailored** — you use the parts that apply to your organization, not necessarily the whole thing.

The book is described as covering the most important parts of the framework (not a 1:1 restatement of the TOGAF Standard itself), supplemented with additional context the author felt was needed (pp. 2-3).

A summary "nutshell" view of TOGAF is given as four sequential ideas (p. 4):

1. **Understanding business needs** — collecting/analyzing business and technology objectives (goals like improving customer experience, digital transformation, optimizing operations).
2. **Designing the architecture** — data management strategies, application integration methods, technology selection, supporting rapid/efficient delivery.
3. **Implementation planning** — developing a flexible, agile, iterative implementation roadmap; prioritizing tasks for a seamless transition; delivering value early and consistently.
4. **Governance and execution** — implementing governance mechanisms to keep the organization aligned with the architectural vision, and continuously evolving the architecture as business needs change.

This sequence maps onto (without yet naming it fully) the **Architecture Development Method (ADM)** (p. 4).

Important caveat repeated at the end of this section (p. 5): **not everything in the TOGAF Standard needs to be used in its entirety — tailoring the framework is a must.**

1.1. Why This Book (pp. 5-7)

Restates that TOGAF is the world's most widely used/applied EA framework and is considered the *de facto* standard, but it does attract criticism (p. 5). Three real quotes the author collected are given as examples of common criticism (p. 5):

- "Real examples demonstrating the actual practical usage of TOGAF's recommendations are missing."
- "TOGAF's prescriptions are vague and inarticulate since it only states that the ADM should be adapted without specifying how."
- "Using TOGAF can be best explained as studying TOGAF and then doing something else instead."

The author calls this criticism "mostly unfounded" but concedes the core, legitimate complaint (p. 6): **TOGAF describes the *what*, not the *how***. The ADM phases describe *what* may be done to

define/deploy an EA; guidance on **how** to actually do it is supposed to live in the **TOGAF Series Guides**, but even there it's under-articulated — an "omission" in the author's opinion (p. 6).

The book's stated purpose is to fix this gap: provide practical, pragmatic, example-driven guidance so that readers can actually apply TOGAF theory (directly rebutting the third quote above) (p. 7).

1.2. Who This Book Is For (pp. 7-9)

Aimed primarily at **architects**, whether experienced or new (p. 7). The author splits the intended audience into two groups (p. 8):

- **Those who have reviewed/read the TOGAF Standard** — likely don't actually apply it day-to-day (or think they don't), often because the theory lacks meaningful examples or is too vague to apply. This book is "definitely" for them.
- **Those who have not reviewed/read the TOGAF Standard** — this book is a good starting point; it explains the theory practically and pragmatically with real-world scenarios, addressing the concern that the framework is dense or discussed negatively.

The author notes TOGAF's theory is necessarily extensive because it is the **blueprint for Enterprise Architecture**, and EA's scope is broad — the framework must describe all these aspects with minimal ambiguity (p. 8). The book's job is to make that theory accessible (p. 9).

1.3. How to Read This Book (pp. 9-12)

The book gives a **practical translation** of TOGAF's major topics, plus a brief history of the framework's evolution and an explanation of the framework's composition (this composition is covered later, in Chapter 3) (p. 9).

The author's stated goal per topic (p. 9): describe not just the **what** (already done well by TOGAF itself) but the **how** — providing clear implementation steps and clarifying what each topic actually means, supported by illustrations/examples.

Reading tours (pp. 9-11) — the book supports multiple non-linear reading paths through its 22 chapters, shown in **Figure 1-1 (p. 11)**:

- **Pink reading tour** — learn the very basics of the TOGAF Standard.

- **Green reading tour** — learn the major concepts of the TOGAF Standard.
- **Blue reading tour** — dive into the details.
- **Gold reading tour** — content you won't find easily elsewhere.

Each chapter opens with a callout stating which reading tour(s) it belongs to (Chapter 1 itself is part of the **PINK** tour, p. 1). Readers who have already read the TOGAF Standard might follow the blue or gold tours (details / hard-to-find content); those wanting just the major concepts follow green; those wanting only basics follow pink (p. 10). Readers new to TOGAF are advised to read the entire book cover-to-cover to catch all the relationships between parts of the framework — called out as the best way to read the book (p. 10).

Per Figure 1-1 (p. 11), the book's 22 chapters are grouped into 9 parts:

5. **Introduction and Basic Information** — Ch 1 Introduction, Ch 2 Preliminary Notes
6. **Framework and Definitions** — Ch 3 The TOGAF Standard, Ch 4 Architecture Definition
7. **Core Concepts, Governance, and Capability** — Ch 5 Enterprise Metamodel, Ch 6 Content Framework, Ch 7 Architecture Repository, Ch 8 Architecture Governance, Ch 9 Architecture Capability
8. **Roles, Skills, and Domains** — Ch 10 Architecture Roles, Skills, and Competencies, Ch 11 Architecture Domains
9. **Architecture Development Method** — Ch 12 Architecture Development Method, Ch 13 Applying the ADM, Ch 14 ADM Techniques
10. **Maturity and Alignment** — Ch 15 Architecture Maturity Models, Ch 16 Alignment with Other Frameworks
11. **Tailoring, Specializations, and Scenarios** — Ch 17 Tailoring the TOGAF Standard, Ch 18 Agile Architecture, Ch 19 Digital Transformation
12. **Practice and Coherence** — Ch 20 Putting the TOGAF Standard into Practice, Ch 21 The TOGAF Standard on a Page
13. **The End** — Ch 22 Closing Remarks

(Note: Chapters 1-7 in this quiz's scope span the first three of these parts: Introduction/Basic Info, Framework/Definitions, and the start of Core Concepts/Governance/Capability.)

Formatting conventions used throughout the book (unnumbered closing section) (p. 12)

- Numbered references in brackets, e.g. **[13]**, point to sources.

- **Personal experiences/comments** from the author are shown in special formatting (a distinct sentence style).
- High-resolution versions of all figures are downloadable from <https://eawheel.com/books/media/>.
- The book is explicitly **not** a book about ArchiMate or modeling ethics — diagrams don't strictly follow ArchiMate modeling rules, but they reuse the familiar ArchiMate color scheme for recognizability.
- **Further Reading** boxes (marked with a book icon) point to TOGAF Library documents or online resources.
- **Steps** icon marks abbreviated step-by-step instructions.
- All names in examples/case scenarios are fictitious.
- Errata can be reported via <https://eawheel.com/books/errata/>.

Key Terms & Definitions

- **Enterprise Architecture (EA)** (p. 1) — the professional discipline of translating organizational strategy into an executable whole, giving stakeholders insight into the implications of change.
- **Architecture framework** (p. 1) — a reference work describing how to map organizational change and interpret its impact on outcomes/goals, so practitioners don't have to "reinvent the wheel."
- **TOGAF Standard** (p. 2) — described as "the world's leading architecture framework," in use for decades by tens of thousands of architects.
- **Tailoring** (p. 5) — adapting the framework so only the applicable parts are used for a given situation/organization; explicitly called "a must."
- **Fundamental Content** (p. 3) — (detailed in Ch 3 §3.2) the core, durable/stable part of the TOGAF Standard — the "essential scaffolding" across industries, domains, and styles.
- **Series Guides** (p. 3) — (detailed in Ch 3 §3.3) supplementary, faster-evolving guidance documents covering industry-specific, architectural-style-specific, purpose-specific, or problem-specific topics; no longer a permanent part of the TOGAF Framework as of the 10th Edition. Not all Series Guides are relevant in every situation.
- **The TOGAF Standard, 10th Edition** (p. 3) — released April 2022; the edition that split the standard into Fundamental Content and Series Guides.
- **Architecture Capability** (p. 4) — per the author, the entire TOGAF Standard "in a nutshell" boils down to establishing and implementing this capability, which is carried out via architecture roles using architecture skills/competencies.
- **Architecture Development Method (ADM)** (p. 4) — referenced (not yet named directly) via its four-stage nutshell description: understand business needs → design architecture → implementation planning → governance and execution.

- **Reading tours** (pp. 9-11) — the book's four alternate reading paths through its chapters: Pink (basics), Green (major concepts), Blue (details), Gold (hard-to-find content).

Figures & Tables Referenced

- **Figure 1-1 — "Alternative reading tours" (p. 11):** A table/diagram mapping all 22 chapters (grouped into 9 parts) against the four color-coded reading tours (pink/green/blue/gold), showing which chapters belong to which tour(s). Matters because it is the book's navigation map — later chapters each declare which tour(s) they belong to.

Key Takeaways / Exam Focus Points

- TOGAF = "the world's leading architecture framework," used for decades by tens of thousands of architects; considered the de facto EA standard worldwide (p. 2).
- The book's core thesis: TOGAF's main weakness is describing the **what**, not the **how**; Series Guides are supposed to cover "how" but don't do so sufficiently (p. 6).
- Three real-world criticisms of TOGAF quoted in the chapter — memorize the gist of all three: missing practical examples; vague/inarticulate ADM adaptation guidance; "study TOGAF then do something else instead" (p. 5).
- **Tailoring is a must** — you are not expected to use 100% of TOGAF; you select and adapt applicable parts (p. 5).
- The TOGAF Standard, 10th Edition was released **April 2022**, and split content into **Fundamental Content** (durable/stable, the focus of this book) and **Series Guides** (fast-evolving, supplementary, not always relevant) (p. 3).
- The book's "nutshell" summary of the TOGAF approach, in order: (1) understand business needs, (2) design the architecture, (3) implementation planning, (4) governance and execution (p. 4).
- Four reading tours exist: **Pink** (basics), **Green** (major concepts), **Blue** (details), **Gold** (content not easily found elsewhere) (p. 9-11). Chapter 1 itself belongs to the Pink tour (p. 1).
- The book intentionally is NOT a complete restatement of the TOGAF Standard and is NOT about ArchiMate modeling — ArchiMate's color scheme is borrowed only for visual recognizability (p. 12).
- The book has 22 chapters organized into 9 parts (p. 11) — know which part/chapters fall under "Core Concepts, Governance, and Capability" since Chapters 5-9 (part of this quiz's scope) all belong to that group.

Self-Check Questions

Q: According to the author, what is the TOGAF Standard's main real weakness, as opposed to the "unfounded" criticisms?

A: It describes the *what* (recommendations on what may be done) but not sufficiently the *how* (how to actually do it) — and even the Series Guides, which are meant to cover the "how," under-articulate it. (p. 6)

Q: What does "tailoring the framework" mean, and how does the author characterize its importance?

A: It means using only the parts of TOGAF that apply to your own situation/organization, rather than applying the entire framework wholesale. The author calls it "a must." (p. 5)

Q: When was The TOGAF Standard, 10th Edition released, and what structural change did it introduce?

A: April 2022; it divided the Standard into Fundamental Content (durable/stable core) and Series Guides (supplementary, faster-evolving guidance). (p. 3)

Q: What are the four "nutshell" stages of the TOGAF approach described in Chapter 1, in order?

A: (1) Understanding business needs, (2) Designing the architecture, (3) Implementation planning, (4) Governance and execution. (p. 4)

Q: Name the four reading tours introduced in Chapter 1 and what each is meant for.

A: Pink = very basics of TOGAF; Green = major concepts of TOGAF; Blue = dive into the details; Gold = content you won't find easily elsewhere. (pp. 9-11)

Q: Which reading tour does Chapter 1 itself belong to?

A: The Pink reading tour. (p. 1)

Q: What are the two "kinds of people" the book is written for?

A: Those who have already reviewed/read the TOGAF Standard, and those who have not yet reviewed/read it. (p. 8)

Q: Does this book claim to be a complete, one-to-one description of the TOGAF Standard? What does the author recommend instead if a reader wants full coverage of every topic?

A: No — it covers the most important parts plus supplementary context the author felt necessary. For a complete listing of every topic, the author recommends reading the TOGAF Standard itself. (p. 3)

Q: Why do the diagrams in this book use the ArchiMate color scheme even though the book is not about ArchiMate?

A: Purely for recognizability/illustrative purposes — the diagrams do not strictly adhere to ArchiMate modeling guidelines. (p. 12)

Q: What are the 9 parts into which the book's 22 chapters are grouped (per Figure 1-1)?

A: (1) Introduction and Basic Information, (2) Framework and Definitions, (3) Core Concepts, Governance, and Capability, (4) Roles, Skills, and Domains, (5) Architecture Development Method, (6) Maturity and Alignment, (7) Tailoring, Specializations, and Scenarios, (8) Practice and Coherence, (9) The End. (p. 11)

Q: What single concept does the author say the entire TOGAF Standard boils down to "in a nutshell"?

A: The establishment and implementation of the Architecture Capability, carried out via one or more architecture roles using architecture skills and competencies. (p. 4)